

iQOO Z9S Pro soundly beats it at most benchmark tests by a significant margin. I ran the CPU Throttling Test to test the phone's performance stability and it did throttle to 78 per cent of its peak performance, however, here too, the iQOO Z9S Pro shows it up as it did not throttle at all.

Similarly, in GPU benchmarks, the iQOO Z9S Pro and the OnePlus Nord CE4 have quite a lead. Even the Motorola Edge 50 Neo beats the Redmi Note 14 Pro by a small margin. Nevertheless, the scores aren't abysmal for the price. However, in day-to-day usage, I did face some stutters and lag, especially when using the camera app for a prolonged duration and playing games like Call of Duty: Mobile.

Performance-wise, the Redmi Note 14 Pro simply doesn't match up to the likes of the speedy iQOO Z9S and OnePlus Nord CE4, but casual users shouldn't face too many issues. When it comes to software, this is where most Redmi Note devices falter, and unfortunately, the Redmi Note 14 Pro is no exception. While HyperOS is smooth and feature-rich, it is riddled with bloatware. Numerous third-party apps come pre-installed, including games like Block Blast!, Bubble Shooter, and Dust Settle, as well as applications such as Agoda, Fitbit, and Snapchat. In comparison, options like the Nothing Phone (2a) and Motorola Edge 50 Neo offer clean, bloatware-free software, making Redmi's bloatware and ad situation feel like a nightmare.

The phone comes with Android 14 with HyperOS on top and Xiaomi has promised 3 years of software updates and four years of security updates, which is pretty decent.

The Redmi Note 14 Pro also debuts an array of AI features including AI Erase, AI Magic Sky, AI Cutout, and AI Image Expansion. But these aren't implemented to perfection. Something as basic as AI Erase delivers inconsistent results on the Redmi Note 14 Pro. I also tested the phone's AI chops by running several AI benchmarks, and it got a Digit AI-Q Score 56/100, which is a pretty decent score in this price range.

CAMERA

Nestled within the glass camera module of the Redmi Note 14 Pro is a triple camera

setup featuring one standout sensor and two that barely make the cut. The star here is a 50 MP Sony LYT-600 sensor with Optical Image Stabilisation, accompanied by an 8 MP ultrawide camera offering a 120-degree field of view and a rather uninspiring 2 MP macro shooter. In the competitive landscape, phones like the Motorola Edge 50 Neo, with its versatile telephoto lens, and the Nothing Phone (2a), boasting a larger primary sensor and a higher-resolution ultrawide camera, outshine the Redmi Note 14 Pro in the camera department.

In daylight, the primary camera pulls its weight and outputs some stunning results with good dynamic range and detail. Colour reproduction is a tad vibrant, but it works for those who share pictures on social media without any edits. The natural depth of field in close-up shots looks great too. Portrait photography is another highlight in ideal lighting, with good skin tones and detail retention, however, edge detection isn't the best in the segment.

Sadly, the ultrawide camera and macro shooter don't quite reach the same levels of greatness, even in ideal lighting conditions. Detail in the corners of an ultrawide photo is quite soft and the macro camera doesn't always provide usable results as there's no stabilisation. The ultrawide camera also has quite a bit of barrelling issues. In low light, the primary camera does falter a bit. The results are somewhat inconsistent. At times, you will get a crisp shot but there are times when there's some noise introduced. The ultrawide camera and macro cameras aren't very usable in low-light situations. I prefer the Motorola Edge 50 Neo's camera output as it provides more consistent results across different scenarios.

As for video recording, the phone supports 4K at 30 fps from the rear camera and 1080p at 60 fps from the selfie shooter. Videos look good in daylight, but they lose out on detail in indoor settings and low-light situations.

BATTERY LIFE

The phone's battery depleted pretty rapidly with heavy use, especially when gaming or shooting 4K video. I only got about 4.5 hours of screen-on time with heavy use

and 5.5 hours with medium use, which is quite disappointing.

In the PCMark Battery Test, the Redmi Note 14 Pro only ran for 622 minutes or 10 hours and 22 minutes. The OnePlus Nord CE4 showcased much better endurance, so if battery life is your primary concern, you are best off looking elsewhere. The 45 W charging speeds are also pretty slow compared to the competition. The phone charged from 0-100 per cent in 47 minutes.

VERDICT

The Redmi Note 14 Pro brings several premium features to the mid-range segment, staying true to Xiaomi's tradition of offering value-packed devices. Its standout design, with an IP68 rating and Gorilla Glass Victus 2 protection, makes it a durable and stylish option in its price range. The primary camera and the vibrant AMOLED display add to its appeal, especially for casual users who prioritise aesthetics and multimedia.

However, the phone faces tough competition from rivals like the Motorola Edge 50 Neo and the OnePlus Nord CE4, which offer cleaner software experiences and slightly better overall performance. While the Redmi Note 14 Pro's battery and charging speeds are decent for most users, heavy gamers or power users might find alternatives more suited to their needs.

At ₹24,999, the Redmi Note 14 Pro is a solid choice for those who value design and durability, but if you're looking for the best performance or the cleanest software experience, it's worth considering other options in this competitive segment.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 7300 Ultra | GPU: Mali-G615 MC2 | RAM: 8 GB LPDDR4X | Internal Storage: Up to 256 GB UFS 2.2 | OS: Android 14, HyperOS | Display: 6.67" AMOLED, 2712 x 1220 pixels, 68B colours | Refresh Rate: 120 Hz | Cameras: 50 MP Primary + 8 MP Ultrawide + 2 MP Macro | Selfie Camera: 20 MP | Video: Up to 4K@30fps (rear), Up to 1080p@60fps (front) | Battery Capacity: 5,500 mAh | Charging: 45 W TurboCharge | Weight: 190 g | IP Rating: IP68

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